



▲ **ARISAKA YEAR 38/44 CARBINE**

Date 1944

Origin Japan

Barrel 18in (45.72cm)

Caliber 6.5mm

Introduced to Japanese service in 1907, the Arisaka Year 38 rifle was upgraded during World War II. This model is called the Year 38/44 Carbine because it was made in the 38th year of the reign of the Emperor Meiji and was updated in 1944. This short carbine has a folding bayonet hinged beneath the muzzle.



▲ **MAUSER KAR 98K**

Date 1935

Origin Germany

Barrel 23½in (60cm)

Caliber 7.92 × 57mm

The "Karabiner" 98K embodied improvements to the Mauser Gewehr 98 rifle (see p.153) and became the standard German service rifle of World War II. More than 14 million guns were manufactured between 1935 and 1945. A number of variations were produced, including those for mountain troops, paratroops, and snipers. During the war, the original design was simplified to speed up production.



FULL VIEW



▲ **LEE-ENFIELD NO. 4, MK.1**

Date 1939

Origin UK

Barrel 25¼in (64cm)

Caliber .303in

The new Lee-Enfield, which appeared late in 1939, differed very little from the model it replaced – the SMLE Mark III (see p.154). The bolt and receiver (the central body of the firearm containing the operating parts) were modified; the rear sight was a new design and was placed on the receiver and the forestock was shortened, exposing the muzzle. The Number 4 remained in service until 1954.

▼ **ARISAKA TYPE 99**

Date 1939

Origin Japan

Barrel 25¾in (65.5cm)

Caliber 7.7mm

Japan's war experience showed that the 6.5mm round used in the Year 38 rifle was inadequate. The Type 99 used the more potent 7.7mm round. It was available in two versions, a short carbine (shown here) and a standard version, 6in (15.2cm) longer. An oddity of the Type 99 was a folding metal monopod support beneath the forestock (detached from this gun), although this was not rigid enough for its purpose.



▲ **MOSIN-NAGANT CARBINE M1944**

Date 1944

Origin USSR

Barrel 20¼in (51.7cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 54mm

In 1910, the 3-line Mosin-Nagant rifle (see p.147) was modified to produce a carbine by shortening its barrel. In 1938, it was revamped, largely to make it cheaper to manufacture, and in 1944, it attained its final form with the addition of a folding cruciform bayonet. Though it was obsolete by that time, the People's Republic of China began manufacturing copies in 1953.